

leuan King

PRODUCT DESIGN · TECHNICAL ANTHROPOLOGY · BROOKLYN

Portfolio and design language — 2026

akabuild.dev · leuan@ubik.studio

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A product designer and technical anthropologist.

I work on the human side of applied AI: discovery, approval flows, and the interfaces that make agents legible and worth trusting. Plus the agent training, front-end and procedural 3D work behind them.

I co-run **Circleheads**, a two-person Brooklyn studio shipping agents into production. I publish **akaOSS**, an open-source studio for human-in-the-loop AI with five projects and one thesis behind them. Before both I spent three and a half years co-founding **Ubik Studio**, a desktop research platform where agents did the gathering and drafting and the human kept the final say.

I also produce and perform electronic music, which is where the instruments, the album-art engine and the live nights come from.

HOW I WORK

Assist, not complete

Software should hand judgment back at the moment it matters, not present a finished answer and hope. Every product here has a place where it stops and asks.

The record, not the verdict

Show what happened. Do not rank it, score it, or diagnose from it. BodyLog logs activity and never severity; EVAL Kit has humans score, not models.

Drawn, not downloaded

Marks, glyphs, figures and icons are character grids and geometry drawn at runtime. No icon fonts, no sprite sheets — adding an icon means adding a grid.

Quiet by default

One accent, one weight range, hairline borders, no shadows doing work a border can do. Colour appears where it carries meaning and nowhere else.

Server-rendered where it can be

If a thing can be static HTML, it is. Interactivity is spent on the parts that are genuinely interactive.



Circleheads

CO-FOUNDER · PRODUCT DESIGN, FRONT END, DESIGN LANGUAGE

A two-person Brooklyn applied-AI studio. Agents in production, a short senior consulting bench, and original games.

I run product and the whole front end: what gets built, how it is shaped, and the design language it ships in. Blaise runs systems, agent tooling, and the verification layers that keep outputs honest.

- Agents in production for real clients
- A short senior consulting bench, a few engagements a year
- Original games built in the gaps

WHAT I DID

- Set the studio's product direction and what we take on
- Designed and built the entire front end and the design language it ships in
- Ran discovery with clients: watch the work first, then ship agents into it
- Built the approval surfaces that keep a human in control of production agents

STACK

Next.js · TypeScript · design system

STATUS

Active · taking a few engagements a year

STUDIO APPLIED AI AGENTS BROOKLYN



akaOSS

FOUNDER · DESIGN SYSTEM, RESEARCH, ALL FRONT END

The open-source studio for human-in-the-loop AI: five projects, one thesis, and a reproducible research feed.

HITL Kit, EVAL Kit, tag-kit, Collapse and Hologram, published under one design language and one argument — Assist, Not Complete. The research feed is reproducible, not a blog.

- Five projects under one design language
- Assist-Not-Complete, argued and implemented
- A research feed that is reproducible, not a blog

WHAT I DID

- Wrote the Assist-Not-Complete thesis and built the primitives that implement it
- Designed one language across five projects, published as a shadcn registry
- Shipped six npm packages and the documentation site
- Built the research feed so every result is reproducible from its inputs

STACK

React · shadcn registry · npm · MIT

STATUS

Live at akaoss.dev

STUDIO

OPEN SOURCE

HITL AI

RESEARCH



BodyLog

PRODUCT, USER STORY, ALL FRONT END, DESIGN LANGUAGE

An iOS app for tracking any visible body or skin condition between doctor visits.

Acne, psoriasis, eczema, bruising, PT progress. Photos stay on device and the app never diagnoses: it records activity, never severity, and colour tells conditions apart rather than ranking them. Every glyph, badge and body figure is a character grid drawn at runtime — no image assets. Blaise built the image pipeline, SwiftData schema and migrations.

- Activity, never severity — the app makes no judgement
- Every glyph and figure drawn at runtime, no assets
- Photos never leave the device; no network layer exists

WHAT I DID

- Owned the product and the user story end to end
- Built the entire front end in SwiftUI and the design language behind it
- Designed the pixel engine: every glyph, badge and body figure is a grid drawn at runtime
- Set the rules the app refuses to break — activity never severity, no diagnosis, no network

STACK

SwiftUI · SwiftData · iOS 17+ · zero dependencies

PRODUCT IOS SWIFTUI CIRCLEHEADS

STATUS

Four schema versions shipped · TestFlight-bound · \$3/mo or \$25/yr

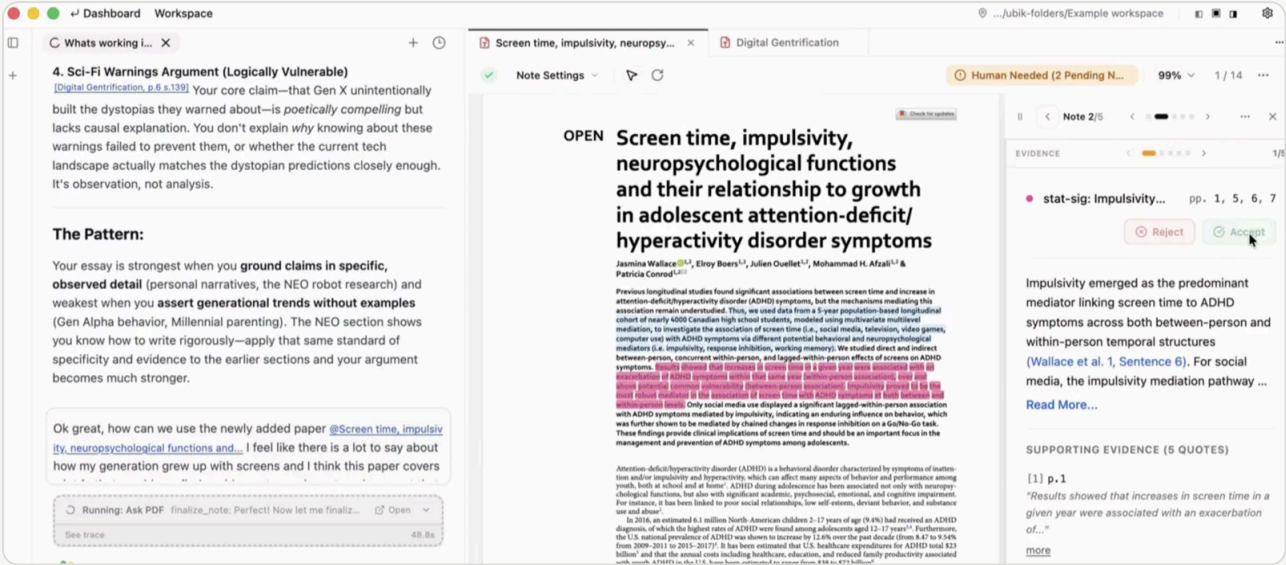
UB

Ubik Studio

CO-FOUNDER · PRODUCT DESIGN, FRONT END

Three and a half years building a desktop-native AI research platform.

Agents gathered, read and drafted; the human kept the final say at every point of judgment, with evidence behind every claim. A review queue stood between every consequential agent action and the workspace it wanted to touch — the human-in-the-loop problem before it had a name.



WHAT I DID

- Co-founded and ran product design for three and a half years
- Designed the three-pane research workspace and the evidence model behind it
- Built the review queue that gates every consequential agent action
- Shaped the Human Needed pattern: the agent stops, states the judgement it needs, and waits

STACK

Desktop · local-first · agentic research

STATUS

2023–2026 · retired; the test log and subreddit remain public

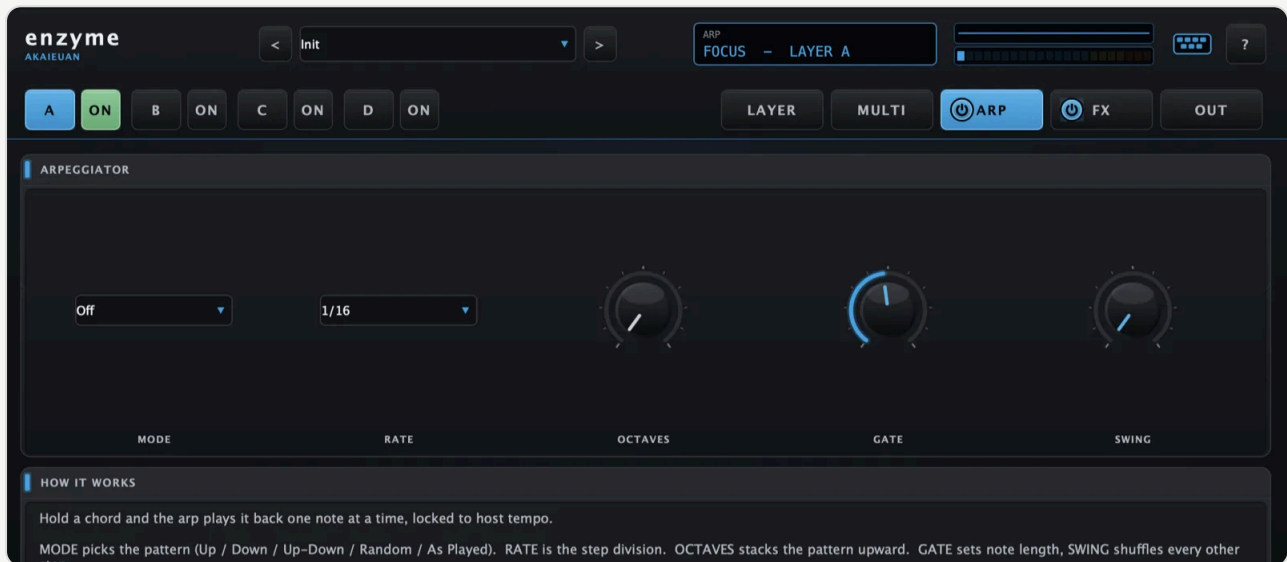


akaVST

SOLE DEVELOPER AND DESIGNER

Three JUCE instruments for macOS, built one at a time and documented as they go.

An acid voice with a 64-step sequencer, four lo-fi layers sharing one voice pool, and a sampler that resamples itself. Each ships with its own interface and its own documentation.



WHAT I DID

- Designed and built three instruments end to end, interface and DSP
- Wrote the 64-step sequencer and the shared voice-pool architecture
- Designed each plugin's interface and shipped its documentation with it

STACK

JUCE · C++ · VST3 / AU

STATUS

v0.4.0, v1.0.0, v0.1.0

INSTRUMENTS

VST3 / AU

JUCE

MACOS

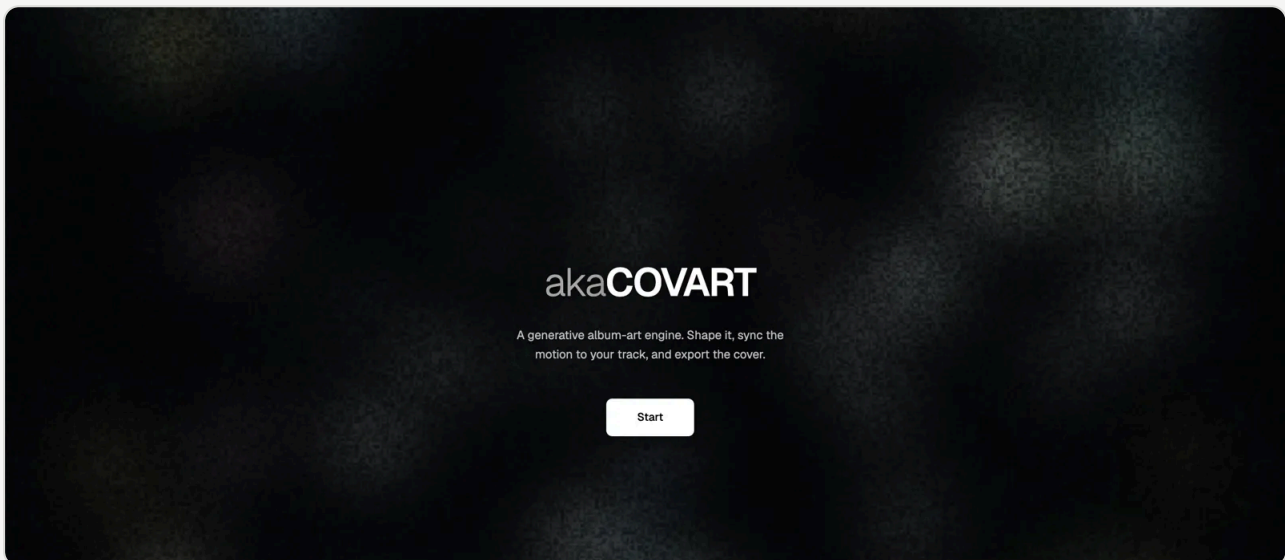


akaCOVART

SOLE DEVELOPER AND DESIGNER

A generative album-art engine: shape it, sync the motion to your track, export the cover.

Every cover is reproducible from an engine, a seed and a few parameters — the same three inputs always give the same artwork, so a cover can be regenerated at any size later.



WHAT I DID

- Designed the engine model: engine + seed + parameters, always reproducible
- Built the generative field engines and the motion sync to an audio track
- Built the export pipeline so a cover can be regenerated at any size later

STACK

Canvas · deterministic PRNG · export pipeline

STATUS

Open source

OPEN SOURCE

GENERATIVE

ALBUM ART

CANVAS

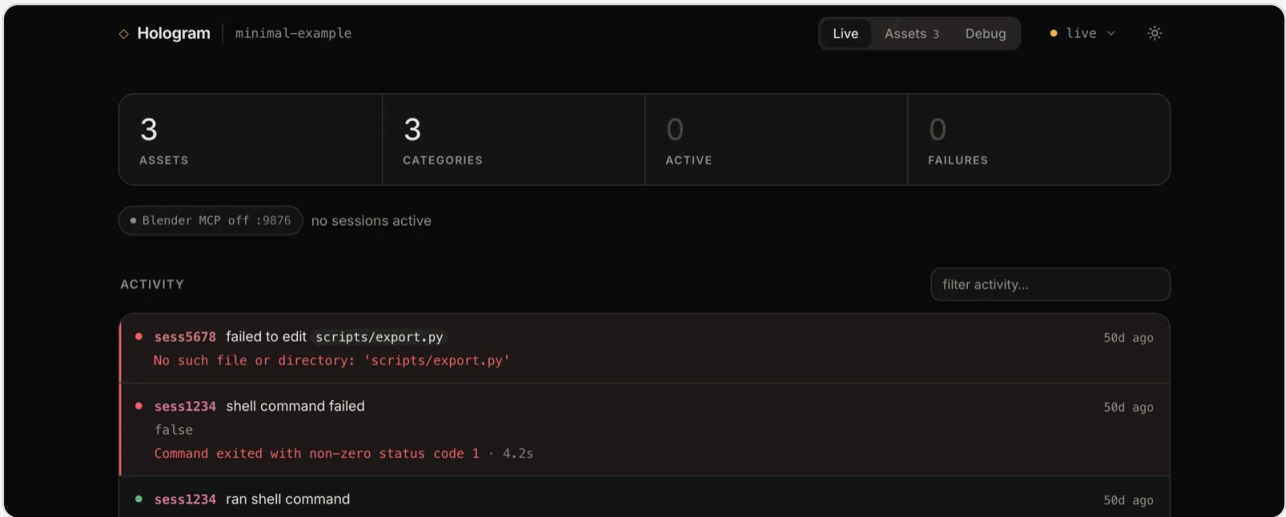


Hologram

SOLE DEVELOPER AND DESIGNER

Live observability and a read-only MCP surface for Blender to glTF pipelines.

It watches an asset pipeline and streams what is happening to a local dashboard — including the tool calls an AI agent is making right now. Deliberately read-only: it observes, introspects and previews, but never modifies your assets.



WHAT I DID

- Designed the read-only contract and held to it: observe, never modify
- Built the MCP surface, the event log and the local dashboard
- Wrote the Claude Code plugin so the pipeline is drivable in plain language

STACK

Python stdlib · MCP · JSONL event log

[OPEN SOURCE](#)

[DEV TOOL](#)

[BLENDER](#)

[MCP](#)

STATUS

Open source, MIT

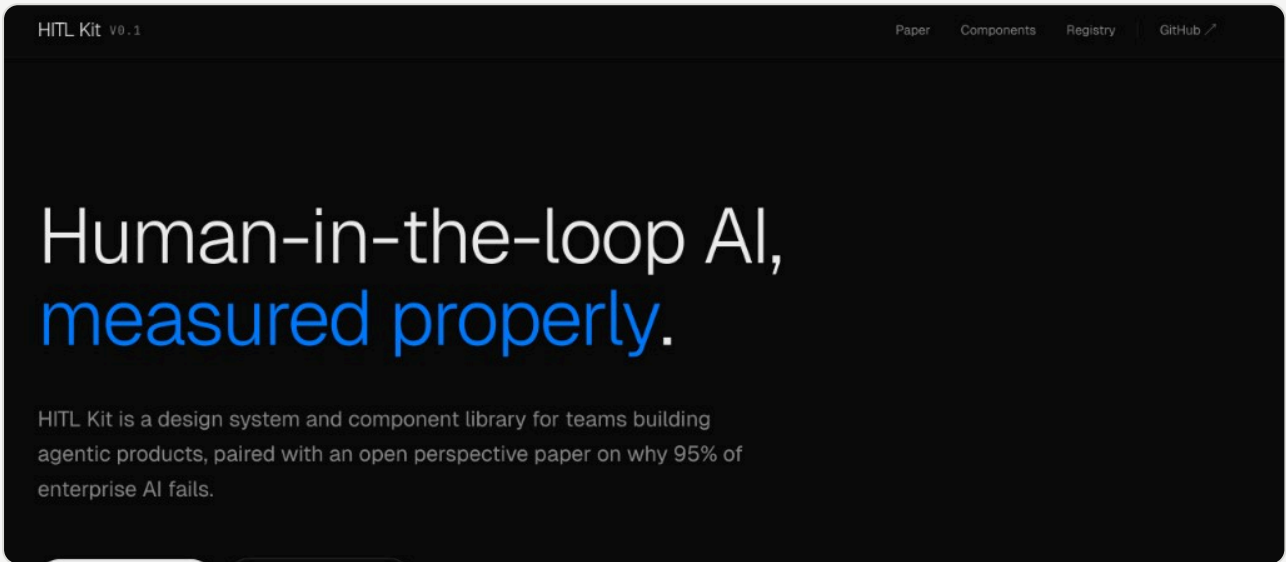


HITL Kit

SOLE DESIGNER AND DEVELOPER

A design system and nineteen human-in-the-loop primitives.

Six npm packages, a shadcn registry, and a research paper arguing the thesis the primitives implement. The components are the argument made concrete.



WHAT I DID

- Designed nineteen human-in-the-loop primitives and the system they share
- Built and published six npm packages and the shadcn registry
- Wrote the research paper the components argue for

STACK

React · TypeScript · shadcn registry

STATUS

Published

[OPEN SOURCE](#) [DESIGN SYSTEM](#) [NPM](#) [WRITE-UP](#)

The rest of the shelf.

Toolkits, demos and side-quests. Every one is written up in full at akabuild.dev/demo.

BO

Box Populi
On-brand site for a NYC live-techno collective. Custom audio players over the SoundCloud Widget, multiple live streams coordinated so...

CLIENT PROJECTLIVE SITENEXT.JS



Collapse
Skills and MCP tools from your lessons. Three pluggable ingestors (MDX, Jupyter/MyST, and a one-file pattern for anything else) feed a...

OPEN SOURCEDEV TOOLCLAUDE CODE



EVAL Kit
Agent eval framework where humans score, not LLMs. LLM-as-judge is only an opt-in pre-fill, flagged on every score. YAML suites, local...

OPEN SOURCEEVALSCLI



Trickle UI Kit
47 pure-CSS text-animation primitives for React. Zero runtime, SSR-safe, copy-paste install via the shadcn registry.

OPEN SOURCEREACTPURE CSS

HO

How I Work
The method behind the site: watch the work first, prototype in code, measure what matters. Plus how the Kit, Research OS, and the public...

NARRATIVEMETHODHITL



User feedback + design log
HITL-AI team test log on Kraa.

HITL-AITEST LOGKRAA

IN

Inertial - Content Moderation Tool
Reference architecture for auditable AI content review: typed signals, YAML policy, hash-chained audit log, reviewer dashboard, eval...

OPEN SOURCEMODERATIONAUDIT LOG



Null Browser
Privacy-first Tauri browser: zero telemetry, local-first AI, six invariants, every connection visible. Pre-v0.1.

OPEN SOURCETAURIPRIVACY

PR

Procedural Asset Pipeline Engineering
Private WIP: procedural Blender→glTF→Godot pipeline, programmatic animation, browser previews.

BLENDERGODOTPIPELINE



Wordle remake: Wrdef (Wordle + definition)
A five-letter guessing game powered by definitions, bonus rounds, and a locally saved dictionary.

GAMENEXT.JSDICTIONARY

RE

Research OS
Multi-panel workspace with agentic search, chat, and human-in-the-loop approval flows.

INTERACTIVE DEMOAGENTSHITL



Music Analysis Chat
Music analytics assistant with roster dashboards, creator discovery, and rich chat blocks.

INTERACTIVE DEMOANALYTICSCHAT

VI

Visualizer Eden
Browser-based 3D audio visualizer with reactive mesh deformation, custom GLSL shaders, and material presets.

AUDIO TOOLWEBGLGLSL

akaSTYLE

One language across the site, the kits and the products. It is small on purpose: four surfaces, one accent, three weights, and a mark engine that draws everything else.

The rules below are the ones that survived contact with real pages. Several of them exist because the alternative was tried first and failed — those are noted, because a design system that only records its conclusions teaches nothing.

Two themes, one structure

Light and dark are not variants of each other; each has its own surface ladder. Every surface token is achromatic — the dark theme carried a warm olive cast for a long time and it made the whole site feel slightly dirty.

Cards sit above the page

The page is the darkest thing in dark mode and the lightest in light mode; cards are one step toward the middle. When cards were darker than the page they had no edge to read against and the grid went flat.

Hue is a whisper

A project's colour appears at 7% behind its mark and nowhere else. Full-strength brand colour on a portfolio grid reads as a toy.

Four surfaces, one accent.

Everything is oklch. Surfaces carry no chroma at all; the only colour in the interface is the accent and the per-project whisper on a stamp.

LIGHT

	<code>--background</code>	<code>oklch(0.97 0.002 106)</code>
	<code>--surface</code>	<code>oklch(0.945 0.004 106)</code>
	<code>--surface-hover</code>	<code>oklch(0.925 0.005 106)</code>
	<code>--surface-border</code>	<code>oklch(0.895 0.004 106)</code>
	<code>--stamp-ground</code>	<code>oklch(0.985 0.002 106)</code>
	<code>--foreground</code>	<code>oklch(0.122 0.001 0)</code>
	<code>--muted-foreground</code>	<code>oklch(0.46 0.001 0)</code>
	<code>--select</code>	<code>oklch(0.58 0.13 250)</code>

DARK

	<code>--background</code>	<code>oklch(0.09 0 0)</code>
	<code>--surface</code>	<code>oklch(0.145 0 0)</code>
	<code>--surface-hover</code>	<code>oklch(0.185 0 0)</code>
	<code>--surface-border</code>	<code>oklch(1 0 0 / 9%)</code>
	<code>--stamp-ground</code>	<code>oklch(0.2 0 0)</code>
	<code>--foreground</code>	<code>oklch(0.985 0 0)</code>
	<code>--muted-foreground</code>	<code>oklch(0.708 0 0)</code>
	<code>--select</code>	<code>oklch(0.707 0.108 152.216)</code>

One accent token. `--select` drives the active tab, text selection and the focus ring — blue on light, green on dark. Nothing else in the interface is allowed to be the accent.

Mix in srgb, not oklch. `--card` is achromatic but written with an explicit hue of 0, so `color-mix(in oklch, ...)` interpolates every accent's hue toward red. A green, a blue and a violet all came out pink. Surface mixes use srgb.

Three weights, one family.

Inter throughout, at 200/300/500. Nothing is bold. Headings are sentence case and often lowercase; the interface never shouts.

HERO	I build tools and create art.
------	-------------------------------

SECTION H2	Why it exists
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CARD TITLE	Circleheads
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BODY	An iOS app for tracking any visible body or skin condition between doctor visits.
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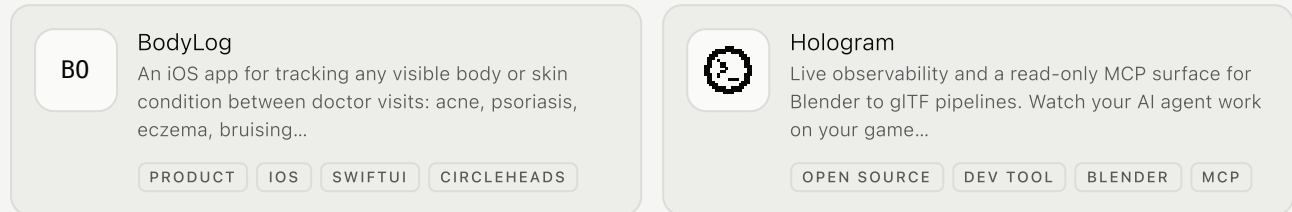
KICKER	PROJECTS
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TAG	OPEN SOURCE
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Container. Content is capped at 1180px with a responsive inset (20–64px). Long-form pages narrow to 672px. The demo rail is positioned inside the same container as the header, so its left edge lands on the wordmark's line at every width.

One shape for everything.

Mark stamped top-left; title, description and up to four tags stacked to its right. The landing grid, the project index and the link tabs all use it, so a wall of projects and a wall of links read as one system.



The stamp is 44px, rounded 10px, bordered, with the project's hue at 7% behind the mark. Bitmap logos and screenshots fill it edge to edge on a dark ground — Box Populi's mark is white on transparent and disappears on a light one. Wordmarks too wide to survive 44px (Trickle at 6.8:1) fall back to a two-letter monogram.

What this replaced. The card used to carry a generated pixel field behind the mark — a dithered gradient, seeded per project, animated on hover. It was removed. A texture loud enough to notice competed with the very clean logos it was meant to support, and no amount of tuning the motion fixed that. The page weight fell from 78 kB to 26 kB gzipped when it went.

Everything is a grid.

Marks, glyphs, badges and body figures are character grids or geometry sampled on a lattice and drawn at runtime. There are no icon assets anywhere in the system.



The hero mark is a disc of cells with a subject knocked out of it. It dissolves and reforms, and each reform reveals a different discipline — AI, code, music, procedural 3D, agent tooling, design. The dissolve is quantized to nine frames and each cell jumps whole cells from a seeded hash, which is what gives it its stutter.

Shared geometry. The knockouts live in one module that both the animating canvas and the server-rendered marks import, so a shape added once appears in both.

A knockout is not a background. The same construction was tried behind the cards and read as a second logo competing with the real one. Silhouettes belong in marks; backgrounds get texture or nothing.

Motion earns its place.

Transform and opacity only

Nothing animates a property that triggers layout. Hover states stay on the compositor.

Gate on the pointer, not the width

Every hover rule sits inside `(hover: hover)` and `(pointer: fine)`. On a touch screen `:hover` latches after a tap and never releases — a looping animation would run until the page was left. Tailwind's own hover utilities are gated too, via `hoverOnlyWhenSupported`.

Suppress transitions on theme change

Every `transition-colors` animates when the theme class flips, so borders flash through an intermediate colour. `next-themes'` `disableTransitionOnChange` kills them for the one frame the swap takes.

Reduced motion wins everywhere

The `prefers-reduced-motion` override is deliberately ungated: it applies regardless of pointer, and the canvas mark renders one assembled frame instead of looping.

Pause what is off screen

The canvas mark stops on an `IntersectionObserver` and on `visibilitychange`. An animation nobody is looking at is a bug.

How this document was made.

Generated from the site itself. Project copy is read from the project index, colour tokens from the stylesheet, and the marks are the same `currentColor` SVGs the site ships — so this cannot drift from what is actually live.

Set in Inter. Built as paged HTML and printed to PDF.

Ieuan King

akabuild.dev

ieuan@ubik.studio

linkedin.com/in/ieuan-king · github.com/akaieuan